Unit 8 — Inequality and Voice

Track E · Klasse 9 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short text on a social issue and identify the writer's perspective.*
- *I can use despite / in spite of / because of* + noun.
- *I can write a 150-word reflection that takes a clear position.*

Lead-in I

Eli's class read a short text about food inequality in their own town. The school cafeteria is free for students who qualify. The qualification is invisible — the cards look the same. Mr. Yilmaz pointed out that the cards were redesigned three years ago precisely so they would all look the same. "That's a small thing," Naima said. Mr. Yilmaz nodded. "Small things do most of the work."

Vocabulary I

- inequality
- fairness
- access
- opportunity
- privilege
- disadvantage
- support
- scholarship
- subsidy
- free school meals
- social mobility
- discrimination

Vocabulary I

- exclusion
- inclusion
- voice
- representation

Reading I

Vocabulary — inequality
inequality, fairness, access, opportunity, privilege, disadvantage, support, scholarship, subsidy, free school meals, social mobility, discrimination, exclusion, inclusion, voice, representation.

Grammar — *despite* / *in spite of* / *because of*
All three take **a noun** or **-ing verb**, not a full clause:

- *Despite the rain, we played football.*
- *In spite of the noise, she focused.*

Reading II

- *Because of the new rule, prices changed.*

For full clauses, use *although* or *because*.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Choose: *despite / in spite of / because of*: _____ the rain, we played. _____ the new policy, prices fell.
2. Build a sentence with *despite* + *noun*: *(rain / we / played)* → ___ .

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 sentences using *despite, in spite of, because of, although* about a fairness topic.

Your turn I

Reflection, 150 words. Take a clear position on a small fairness issue. Use 2 *despite/because of* + 1 *although* + 1 strong claim sentence.

Sample

The school redesigned its lunch cards three years ago, so that the cards of students who qualify for free meals look exactly the same as everyone else's. It's a small thing. Despite the small surface, the effect is real: no student has to walk past a different-coloured card on the way to the trays. Although adults sometimes call this kind of detail cosmetic, I disagree. Because of one design choice, the cafeteria queue stops being a place where income is visible. In my view, a school is most fair when its smallest details have been thought through this carefully. Posters on the wall

Your turn II

are easy. Cards in pockets are not.

Reflect I

- I can read a fairness text and find the writer's perspective.
- I can use *despite / in spite of / because of* with nouns.
- I can write a 150-word reflection with a clear position.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC News — *Education* social-issue articles.
- JRF (Joseph Rowntree Foundation, UK) — accessible reports.